

Barbecue Around the World

The first Southerners to barbecue were native Florida Indians, but as America developed, so did several regional styles of barbecue, using different cuts of meat, sauces, spices, and cooking methods. Other countries, such as South Africa, Kenya, and Brazil, have their own strong barbecue traditions.

MEMPHIS

Central BBQ inexpensive—moderate

2249 Central Ave.; www.cbqmemphis.com

Join the college students on the outdoor deck for award-winning pork plates, ribs, and hot wings, cooked up by two veterans of the Memphis in May World Championship Barbecue Contest.

Charlie Vergos' Rendezvous
moderate

52 South Second St.; www.hogsfly.com

Customers form a line down the alley to enter this basement rib joint, which has been serving up some of the city's best barbecue since 1948. Red-checked tables and Memphis memorabilia are arranged around the barbecue pit.

Corky's moderate

5259 Poplar Ave.; www.corkysmemphis.com

Old-fashioned, slow-cooked, hickory-smoked ribs and hand-pulled pork, the hits of the '50s and '60s, and the down-home decor of barn wood walls and cheery neon make this a Memphis favorite.

TEXAS

Barbecue means beef in Texas, where there are several regional styles. The East Texas (marinated in sweet tomato-based sauce) and Central Texas (dry-rubbed with spices and smoked over oak or pecan) barbecues are most popular.

Black's Barbecue inexpensive

215 N. Main St., Lockhart; www.blacksbbq.com

Black's is the oldest family-run barbecue restaurant in Texas (since 1932), and still the best, according to its many fans. Their tender beef brisket and homemade sausage are made to secret family recipes.

Railhead Smokehouse inexpensive

2900 Montgomery St., Fort Worth; www.railheadonline.com

This simple but lively Fort Worth barbecue joint is the place to go for the tenderest and tastiest beef brisket, ribs, pork tenderloin, and smoked sausage here in "Cow Town."

Artz Rib House moderate

2330 South Lamar, Austin; www.artzribhouse.com

Mesquite-smoked baby back ribs, country-style pork ribs, brisket, and sausage top the menu here, and you can order some of each. They're served up with a nightly helping of country and bluegrass music.

NORTH AND SOUTH CAROLINA

Pulled pork is king in North Carolina, where either a whole hog or a choice shoulder of pork is slow-cooked until it pulls gently off the bone. South Carolina tops it with Carolina Gold, a unique yellow sauce made from mustard, brown sugar, vinegar, and spices.

Speedy's Barbecue inexpensive

1317 Winston Rd., Lexington, North Carolina; www.speedysbbqinc.com

Set in a former drive-in, Speedy's still offers curbside service for those who can't wait for their barbecue sandwiches, plates, and trays—all served in extra-large portions with their delicious special sauce.

Sweatman's Bar-b-que inexpensive

1313 Gemini Drive, Holly Hill, South Carolina; (803) 492 7543

In an old wooden house under a pecan tree, this weekend barbecue joint serves some of the most delicious, pit-cooked pulled pork and ribs you'll find, served with authentic mustard sauce and "cracklins" (crispy pork crackling).

Wilber's Barbecue inexpensive

4172 Highway 70 E., Goldsboro, North Carolina; www.wilbersbarbecue.com

They cook the whole hog at Wilber's. Presidents Clinton and George Bush Sr. have tucked into their pit-cooked, oakwood-flavored pork, chopped and served with potato salad, hush puppies (cornbread fritters), and coleslaw.

